

WordPress to Supabase Detailed Migration Plan

Taunet Nelel Community Website

Prepared: 23 July 2026

Source: <https://www.taunetnelel.org/>

Target UI: <https://taunetnelel.vercel.app/>

Target backend: One Supabase project (PostgreSQL + Auth + Storage)

WordPress (MySQL/MariaDB) -> Supabase (PostgreSQL) + static UI on Vercel. One Supabase project serves both the Vercel clone and the real domain after cutover.

1. Purpose

Migrate the live Taunet Nelel website off WordPress onto:

- 1. Frontend: the existing static clone (Vercel / this repo) as the new public UI
- 2. Backend: one Supabase project for database, auth, forms, and media metadata

WordPress stays live until cutover. The Vercel clone and the real domain will share the same Supabase project when you go live.

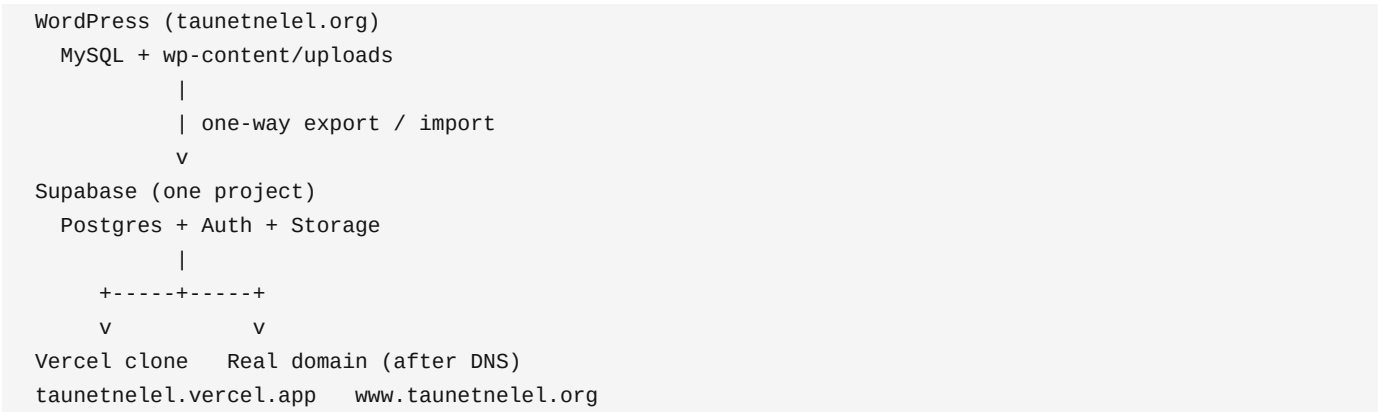
2. Important clarification: WordPress vs PostgreSQL

System	Database in practice
WordPress (taunetnelel.org)	Almost always MySQL or MariaDB (not PostgreSQL)
Supabase	PostgreSQL (managed)

Migration path: WordPress + MySQL/MariaDB -> Supabase (PostgreSQL) + static UI on Vercel.

Do not move WordPress tables as a full dump. Extract the content you need and load it into the Supabase schema already defined in this repository (supabase/migrations/001_initial_schema.sql).

3. Target architecture



Rules during migration:

- One Supabase project for both the unreal (Vercel) UI and the real site after cutover
- Do not point WordPress at Supabase
- Do not couple the clone to WordPress APIs
- Migration tooling talks WordPress/MySQL -> Supabase only

4. What already exists in the clone

4.1 Supabase schema (ready to run)

	Table
form_submissions	Contact, membership, sponsorship, welfare, events, support
sponsors	Sponsorship directory (tiers, logos, contacts)
profiles	Member profile (linked to Supabase Auth)
events	Upcoming / past events

Table	Purpose
newsletter_subscribers	Newsletter emails
gallery_albums	Gallery album metadata
gallery_photos	Photo rows + storage paths
businesses	Business directory
business_news	Business hub news

RLS policies are included. Run 002_fix_security_warnings.sql after 001 if not already applied.

4.2 Clone UI status

		Capabili
Static pages	Done in HTML	
Forms -> Supabase	Wired when config is set; else FormSubmit email	
Events content	Still largely in events-phases.js	
Gallery	Still largely in gallery-data.js	
Business directory	Still largely in business-content.js	
Member area	Demo / localStorage - replace with Supabase Auth	
Sponsors	Seeded in SQL; page may still be partly static	

4.3 Live WordPress surface (inventory starting point)

- Home, About, Events (upcoming + past), Membership, Sponsorship, Gallery
- Contact / enquiries, Join / Donate CTAs, Login
- Media under wp-content/uploads/
- Users / members (WP users or membership plugin)
- Forms (Contact Form 7, Gravity, etc.) and stored entries
- Business / community listings if present as posts or CPTs

5. Migration principles

1. Content, not WordPress schema - map meaning into Supabase tables
2. WordPress stays authoritative until cutover - final sync before DNS change
3. Passwords do not transfer - members reset via Supabase Auth
4. Media is a separate workstream - files to Storage + paths in DB
5. Phased go-live - forms and read-only content first; Auth next; DNS last
6. One Supabase project - Vercel and production share it; mark or clean test rows

6. Phased plan

Phase 0 - Access, inventory, backups (Week 0-1)

Goals: Safe rollback and a complete list of what to move.

1. Collect access: WordPress admin, hosting, DNS, GitHub, Vercel, Supabase
2. Full backup: MySQL dump, wp-content/uploads, Tools > Export (WXR), forms/plugins settings
3. Store backups offline and label with date
4. Inventory spreadsheet: Content type | WP location | Count | Target table | Owner | Priority
5. Confirm DB engine (MySQL/MariaDB) and hosting expiry dates
6. Decide cutover window (low-traffic weekend preferred)

Exit criteria:

- [] SQL + uploads + WXR backups verified readable
- [] Inventory signed off by committee lead

Phase 1 - Supabase foundation (Week 1)

Goals: Empty but production-ready backend shared by clone and future real site.

1. Confirm Supabase project region (prefer Australia-adjacent)
2. Save DB password and project ref securely
3. Run 001_initial_schema.sql and 002_fix_security_warnings.sql
4. Create Storage buckets: media (public), gallery-member (private), private-docs (private)
5. Prepare Auth: email on; Site URL = Vercel; add production domain later
6. Fill supabase-config.js with Project URL + anon key only (never service_role in browser)
7. Deploy to Vercel; submit a test contact form; confirm row in form_submissions

Exit criteria:

- [] All tables + RLS present
- [] Test form visible in Table Editor
- [] Storage buckets created

Phase 2 - Extract and transform WordPress data (Week 1-2)

Goals: Clean CSV/JSON ready for Supabase. Do not import raw wp_* tables.

Extraction methods:

Method	When to use
WordPress XML export	Pages, posts, basic media URLs
MySQL queries / CSV	Custom post types, users, form entries
Manual spreadsheet	Small sponsor / business lists
One-off import script	Larger galleries or repeated imports

Field mapping highlights:

- Events -> events (id, title, summary, location, start_at/end_at, image_path, flags)
- Sponsors -> sponsors (name, tier, logo_url, contacts, sort_order) - reconcile seed data
- Gallery -> gallery_albums + gallery_photos (Storage paths)
- Business -> businesses / business_news
- Members -> Supabase Auth + profiles (passwords do not transfer)

- Form history (optional) -> form_submissions
- Static page copy: keep in clone HTML unless you add a CMS later

Media steps: download uploads, dedupe, upload to Storage with clear paths, rewrite URLs, keep redirect map.

Exit criteria:

- ☐ Transformed datasets reviewed (sample rows)
- ☐ Media uploaded for priority albums/events/sponsors
- ☐ Duplicate sponsor seed reconciled

Phase 3 - Load data into Supabase (Week 2)

Import order: sponsors -> events -> gallery_albums/photos -> businesses/news -> Auth/profiles -> optional forms.

1. Use Table Editor CSV for small sets; service_role scripts only on a secure machine for bulk loads
2. Validate counts: WP inventory vs Supabase count(*)
3. Spot-check 10 random records (text, dates, image URLs)
4. Freeze WordPress edits during final import, or plan a delta re-import

Exit criteria:

- ☐ Row counts match agreed inventory
- ☐ Published flags correct
- ☐ Broken image paths empty for P0 content

Phase 4 - Member authentication migration (Week 2-3)

1. Export member emails + profile fields from WP
2. Create Auth users via Admin API / invite emails (do not copy password hashes)
3. Backfill profiles (plan, member number, renewals) after handle_new_user trigger
4. Replace localStorage demo in members.js with Supabase Auth sessions
5. Email members: new URL, set password / magic link, support contact
6. Test register, login, logout, reset, profile, welfare-gated pages

Exit criteria:

- ☐ Committee test accounts work end-to-end
- ☐ At least one real member completes invite flow in UAT

Phase 5 - Wire the clone UI to Supabase reads (Week 3)

1. Forms - confirm all data-supabase-form pages write successfully
2. Events page - load from events table
3. Sponsorship - load from sponsors
4. Gallery - albums/photos from Supabase + Storage
5. Business hub - businesses / business_news
6. Newsletter - newsletter_subscribers
7. Optionally keep FormSubmit as backup, then remove when stable

Phase 6 - Parallel run / UAT (Week 3-4)

Keep WordPress live for the public. Committee UAT only on Vercel.

- ☐ Home / About / Community copy
- ☐ Events list + enquiry form
- ☐ Membership + sponsorship forms
- ☐ Gallery view + download rules

- [] Member login + profile
- [] Business listings
- [] Contact form -> form_submissions
- [] Mailto / phone / social links
- [] Privacy / terms pages

Exit criteria: UAT sign-off; open P0 bugs = 0.

Phase 7 - Cutover to real domain (Week 4)

1. Final data delta sync from WordPress -> Supabase
2. Put WordPress in maintenance mode (or freeze publishing)
3. Add www.taunetnelel.org (and apex) on Vercel
4. Update DNS; lower TTL to 300s a day before cutover
5. Add production Site URL + redirects in Supabase Auth
6. Update hardcoded Vercel URLs in forms/emails to the real domain
7. Verify HTTPS, forms, login, key pages on real domain
8. Optional 301 redirects from old WP permalinks
9. Monitor 48-72 hours
10. Keep WordPress hosting for 2-4 weeks after cutover

Phase 8 - Decommission WordPress (Week 6+)

1. Final WP backup archived permanently
2. Export remaining form/plugin data
3. Cancel WP host only after committee confirmation
4. Document Supabase billing, owners, and recovery contacts

7. One Supabase project for real + Vercel

Environment	URL	Supabase
Unreal / staging UI	taunetnelel.vercel.app	Same project
Real site (after cutover)	www.taunetnelel.org	Same project

- Test form submissions on Vercel appear in the same form_submissions table
- Mitigate with test+ emails, cleanup, or metadata.source later
- Do not delink Vercel from Supabase to go live - add the real domain to Vercel and Auth

8. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Project lead	Timeline, UAT sign-off, cutover decision
Content owner	Inventory accuracy, copy QA
Technical	Exports, imports, schema, UI wiring, DNS
Committee tester	Forms, login, events, gallery checks

9. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Missing media after cutover	Full uploads backup; Storage before DNS; URL map
Member password friction	Clear invite email; magic link; help contact
SEO / broken old links	Vercel redirects; map key WP URLs
RLS blocking public content	Test anon reads on Vercel before cutover
Editors still updating WP	Freeze window + final delta import
service_role in frontend	Only anon key in supabase-config.js
Mixed test + real form data	Test naming convention; cleanup query

10. Rollback plan

Before DNS cutover: keep using WordPress; fix Supabase/clone offline.

After DNS cutover (within TTL window):

1. Point DNS back to WordPress host
2. Re-enable WordPress if in maintenance mode
3. Investigate issues on Vercel URL
4. Re-attempt cutover only after sign-off

Rollback is primarily DNS/hosting, not deleting the Supabase database.

11. Suggested timeline (4 weeks core)

Week	Focus
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Week	Focus
1	Backups, inventory, Supabase schema, Storage, form smoke test
2	Extract/transform/load events, sponsors, gallery, businesses
3	Auth + profiles; wire UI reads; committee UAT
4	Final sync, DNS cutover, monitor
6+	Archive and decommission WordPress

12. Definition of done

1. www.taunetnelel.org serves the clone UI
2. Public content served from Supabase (or accepted as static HTML)
3. Forms persist in form_submissions
4. Members authenticate via Supabase Auth with profiles populated
5. WordPress is backed up and scheduled for decommission
6. Phase 7 exit criteria are checked off

13. Working checklist

Prep

- ☐ WP admin + hosting + DNS access confirmed
- ☐ MySQL dump saved and verified
- ☐ wp-content/uploads downloaded
- ☐ WXR export saved
- ☐ Content inventory spreadsheet complete

Supabase

- ☐ Project created (AU-near region)
- ☐ 001 + 002 migrations applied
- ☐ Storage buckets created
- ☐ Auth URLs configured (Vercel + later production)
- ☐ supabase-config.js set; test form OK on Vercel

Data

- ☐ Events imported
- ☐ Sponsors reconciled
- ☐ Gallery albums/photos + media uploaded
- ☐ Businesses / news imported
- ☐ Members invited + profiles backfilled

UI

- ☐ Forms writing to Supabase
- ☐ Events page reads Supabase
- ☐ Sponsorship reads Supabase
- ☐ Gallery reads Supabase
- ☐ Member login uses Supabase Auth

Cutover

- ☐ UAT signed off
- ☐ Final delta sync done
- ☐ Domain on Vercel
- ☐ DNS updated
- ☐ Production Auth redirects updated
- ☐ 72h monitoring complete
- ☐ WP archived / hosting cancelled (later)

14. Reference links

- Live WordPress: <https://www.taunetnelel.org/>
- Clone UI: <https://taunetnelel.vercel.app/>
- Supabase docs: <https://supabase.com/docs>
- Local setup: docs/supabase/SETUP.md
- Schema: supabase/migrations/001_initial_schema.sql
- Markdown source: docs/migration-guides/WORDPRESS-TO-SUPABASE-MIGRATION-PLAN.md

15. Next actions (immediate)

1. Complete Phase 0 backups and inventory against the live site
2. Confirm MySQL access (phpMyAdmin or host DB tools)
3. Ensure migrations 001 / 002 are applied on your Supabase project
4. Connect Vercel clone forms (SETUP.md) and verify one submission
5. Start Phase 2 with events + sponsors (highest public value, lower risk than full Auth)

Saved locally: docs/migration-guides/WORDPRESS-TO-SUPABASE-MIGRATION-PLAN.pdf